

Several times during his testimony, both on examination and cross examination, the defendant Krauch had referred to a "defensive war". He had emphasized at one point in

his testimony ~~the fact~~ that Germany had built ^{the} Westwall (between France and Germany, a few miles from and paralleling the Maginot Line) as a defensive measure. Practically every de-

fendant who took the stand ^{had} laid emphasis on this idea, namely ~~that~~ to the extent that Germany was preparing for war, it was a "defensive war" as distinguished from an "aggressive

war". I proceeded to ~~examine~~ examine Krauch to determine just what he meant when he referred to a "defensive war".

INTERCHANGE
Now, in your testimony you spoke of the construction of the Westwall as an urgent project, requiring a great deal of building materials, as interfering to some extent with the Karinhall plan, and you declared the Westwall as having been constructed for defensive purposes. Now, in what sense do you consider the construction of the Westwall for defensive purposes?"

"It was intended for the event of war that an attack might be made on Germany from the West. Here in the West were the industrial centers of the German Reich; and it was quite in line with the idea of defense for a wall to be built here to protect these industrial areas. A similar measure had been taken by the French. Immediately after the ~~First~~ First World War they built the Maginot Line ~~at~~ against an attack from Germany. The Westwall is approximately equal to the Maginot Line as far as its defensive capacity is concerned."

"Well, now, you recall that you had testified that in the speeches of Goering and Hitler in December 1936, they stressed the danger of invasion from the East and discussed precautionary measures to be taken now, in the light of this. How did you reconcile, in your own mind, the fact that a Westwall was erected for what you describe "for defensive purposes" and that no comparable wall was erected in the East?"

"Germany, in the First World War, had experienced the enormous consequences of a two-front war. I am not a military man, and I cannot judge the thought processes of the General Staff; I can speak only as a layman. But it is possible that it was considered that in the East the terrain was not quite so suitable for the construction of such a wall. As far as I know, and I know very little about the matter, mountains, rivers, etc. are necessary on which the defense can be based. Perhaps the situation was not so good in the East as in the West. Perhaps the General Staff intended to rely on pure defense in the West, similar to that of the First World War, and to have mobile warfare in the East — a different type of defense."

A noble effort to explain away what I thought must now be common knowledge, even among the members of the Tribunal! It had been generally conceded for sometime that Germany